PRW FY27-28 Budget Balancing Measures

General Fund 12.5% Reductions and Impacts

- **Youthworks Division:** There will be **39 fewer youth internships**, reducing the summer program from 142 to 103 internships for Berkeley residents with a focus on historically underserved communities. Summer internships had already decreased from 267 in 2024 to 142 in 2025 when the budget was right-sized. This reduces the City's ability to meet high community need, with more than 500 applicants in 2025, and more than 600 applicants expected in 2026.
- **Recreation Division:**
    - **Reductions of 4.0 FTE** (Including the AFS that is being held vacant from FY26) This elimination of 14% of Recreation programming staff combined with the **2.46 FTE cost shifts** to the Camps Fund and Parks Tax Fund, will require a division-wide reorganization, further reductions in programs due to lack of supervision and coordination, and realignment of existing budget to meet the need for increased scholarships due to cuts in programs designed for low-income participants.
    - Projected impacts of program reductions due to division-wide staffing cuts include:
        - **Partial pools closure (weekly or seasonal).** This could be closing on weekends, or one weekend day, at one or both pools. Currently, on average, 172 patrons visit King Pool and 124 patrons visit West Campus Pool each weekend. Examples of weekend programs are lap swim, independent exercise, senior exercise, community/family swim, and swim lessons. Alternatively, one pool could be closed during the winter season. This was the case prior to 2019, when West Campus Pool opened only during summer months. This past year, we had 12,106 visits to West Campus Pool during the off-season.
        - **Elimination of Therapeutic Recreation** (special needs) programming. Currently, our TR program provides additional support for up to 21 youth with special needs to participate in summer camp and afterschool programs.
        - **50 % Reduction of Teen Friday night drop-in program, trips and special events.** Currently we offer drop-in every Friday night, Teen trips

throughout the year to Echo Lake, Six Flags/Great America, Santa Cruz Boardwalk, Cal games, and the Black College Expo; We also host special events like the Teen Flashlight Egg-Hunt, Teen Dances, and Middle School Pool Parties; Over 1000 teens attended these events over the last year.

- **50% Reduction of family-oriented/DEI special events.** PRW hosts more than 80 special events each year, ranging from the Harvest Festival and Bay Festival, to Music and Movies in the Park, the Community Picnic, Skate Night, Game Nights, Live Oak Laughs, and Mothers' Day Hats and High Tea. An estimated 20-25,000 people attend these events.
- **Reduction of Tots and Pre-K programs.** PRW provides a variety of popular programs for families with children under 5, including summer and spring break camps, Shooting Star Preschool, Wee-Play Drop In, and music camps. An estimated 150 participants per week attend drop-in programs; and 168 participants attend pre-k camp programs throughout the year.
- **Reduction of Summer Camp and Afterschool Program slots.** With reductions in career staffing, summer camp slots may need to be reduced by 36 to ensure appropriate supervision. Similarly, 36 slots per week would need to be reduced from afterschool programs (this represents 12 slots at each location between Frances Albrier, Live Oak and James Kenney.
- **Reduction of Community Center hours.** Career staff are responsible for scheduling, programming and supervising part-time staff so that community centers can stay open in the evenings and some weekends. Reductions will include hour s after 6pm, traditionally our centers are open till 9 or 10 pm.

- **Program reductions create the need for additional scholarships.** As an example, closure of the City's Playground Program, which is fully subsidized by the General Fund, would displace 72 participants each week during the summer. The Playground Program is our low-cost summer camp option where participants pay $10/week to attend. Those 72 families would still need to find care for their children, and would likely need scholarships to participate in higher-cost City programs. This cycle of subsidized program closures increasing demand for scholarships for other programs will likely lead to pressures to increase the budget for scholarships and reduce eligibility thresholds.

- **Shower Program:** The program currently operates at West Campus Pool 7 days/week, open to the public 1 hour/day. This reduction will result in **program closure approx. 1 day/week** (43 days/year). This reduces access to opportunities for basic hygiene for the unhoused community.
- **Summer Lunch**: The program currently runs at 4 sites, distributing free lunches and snacks. Budget reductions will lead to the **elimination of 1 site**. This creates a higher burden for community members to access free meals, and provides fewer meals and snacks to those who need them. This would affect an estimated 30 people per day each day of the summer.
- **Fire Fuel:** PRW currently receives $450k/year to remove hazardous trees and vegetation. These balancing measures would **reduce fire fuel budget by $243k** to close PRW's budget gap. This work could be funded by FF but has remained GF over the last several years because there are other high priorities for FF funds. In this last budget cycle, PRW removed an estimated 210 tons in fire fuel debris from the Berkeley hills.
- **Administration**: General Fund is currently used to advertise PRW programs and events, produce ribbon cuttings, groundbreakings, and department-wide trainings. Balancing measure will result in **lower-quality public engagement and elimination of all-staff department trainings and.** These will result in less community awareness and understanding of our work, and lower staff morale and knowledge of City priorities.

PRW General Fund Budget Balancing Measures

Division	Description	FY 27 Reduction	FY 28 Reduction
Recreation	1.0 Assistant Recreation Coordinator Reduction	$ 146,164	$ 146,164
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Recreation	1.0 Recreation Activity Leader (R1) Reduction	$ 173,676	$ 176,215
Recreation	Reclass Supervisor to Rec Coordinator	$ 39,748	$ 41,029
Recreation	0.46 Assistant Recreation Coordinator Shift to Camps Fund	$ 67,236	$ 67,236
Recreation	0.60 Recreation Coordinator Reduction Shift to Camps Fund	$ 84,913	$ 89,521
Recreation	0.60 Assistant Recreation Coordinator Reduction Shift to Camps Fund	$ 87,129	$ 89,444
Recreation	0.55 Recreation Coordinator Reduction Shift to Parks Tax	$ 106,981	$ 110,558
Recreation	0.25 Recreation Program Supervisor Reduction Shift to Parks Tax	$ 38,483	$ 39,022
Youth Works	Youth Works Reduction in Internships	$ 164,662	$ 164,662
Summer Lunch	Summer Lunch Budget Reduction	$ 9,003	$ 9,003
Shower Program	Shower Program Budget Reduction	$ 9,543	$ 9,543
Fire Fuel	Fire Fuel Budget Reduction	$ 243,292	$ 243,292
PRW Admin	Admin Budget Reduction	$ 63,837	$ 63,837
	Total GF Reduction	**$ 1,380,830**	**$ 1,395,691**
	Total GF Revenue Increases	**$ 235,358**	**$ 235,358**
	TOTAL GF IMPACT	**$ 1,616,188**	**$ 1,631,049**